

1. Make a DOS bootable disk and boot to DOS using this disk. This disk can either be a floppy disk or a bootable CD-ROM. Generally, a Windows 98 or Windows ME bootable floppy disk is preferred, since making a bootable CD-ROM takes much longer. To make a bootable floppy in Windows 98 or Windows ME, go to Start > Settings > Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs. In the Window that opens, click on the 'Startup Disk' tab. Then insert a blank formatted floppy disk in the floppy drive and click on the 'Create Disk' button.
2. To create a boot disk in Windows XP, insert a formatted floppy disk in the floppy drive. Next, open Windows Explorer (Start > All Programs > Accessories). Right click your floppy drive and click 'Format'. From the dialog box that appears, click 'Create an MS-DOS startup disk'. Windows will place the necessary files on the floppy disk that are required to boot the computer.
3. If you don't have access to Windows 98 or ME systems, you can go to www.bootdisk.com/bootdisk.htm and download the 'Windows 98 SE OEM' file. Once you have this file, double-click it and enter a blank formatted disk in your floppy drive, and the contents of the downloaded file will be extracted to the disk.
4. Next, download the BIOS update file for the motherboard. This is a hit-and-miss step for older motherboards, since you may or may not find the BIOS for your motherboard. Also, it is highly recommended that you download BIOS updates from the motherboard manufacturer's Web site, as you can be sure of what you are downloading. Downloading from third-party Web sites is not recommended.
5. Generally, the motherboard has information on it about the manufacturer and the model. But you will need to spend time on the Internet to locate the correct BIOS for your motherboard. Pay notice to the hardware revision of the motherboard, since some manufacturers such as Asus have different BIOS updates for different hardware revisions for the same motherboard.